
PAPERBOY

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A federal judge told the Pentagon it cannot blacklist an AI company for refusing to build what it asked for.

AI

A federal judge strikes down the Pentagon's Anthropic blacklist

WHAT HAPPENED

US District Judge Rita Lin, in the Northern District of California, ruled on Friday that the Pentagon acted unlawfully when it designated Anthropic a supply-chain risk in February 2026 — a label applied after the company refused to allow Claude to be used for mass surveillance of Americans or for fully autonomous weapons. Lin wrote that "the empty invocation of national security is not a blank check to punish and retaliate against government critics," and pointed out that the department kept trying to buy Anthropic's products while the designation stood: "None of that is consistent with a genuine fear that Anthropic is a saboteur who would poison its software to harm national security." The ruling is carried independently by [Axios](#) and [Al Jazeera](#). A second, separate designation is still being litigated in the DC Circuit.

WHAT IT MEANS

This puts a limit on a tool that had looked unlimited: freezing a vendor out of federal contracting by calling it a security risk, with no showing required. For AI companies it lowers the price of refusing a government customer, which until now was Washington's main lever over model-use policy. The reasoning is narrow — retaliation against a critic — but the fact pattern is not rare.

WATCH NEXT

An appeal to the Ninth Circuit, and the parallel DC Circuit case.

A hundred companies ask governments for help against AI-enabled attacks

WHAT HAPPENED

OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, Microsoft, CrowdStrike, Okta, Fortinet and more than a hundred others signed an [open letter on Thursday](#) calling for coordinated public and private action against AI-driven cyberattacks. "In the coming months, AI-enabled cyber attacks will become far more widespread and sophisticated as models around the world become increasingly capable," it reads. The signatories point to recent agent-escape incidents — among them OpenAI's Hugging Face breach, whose post-mortem landed on Wednesday — and name defensive tools in development: OpenAI's Daybreak, Anthropic's Mythos, Microsoft's Perception.

WHAT IT MEANS

Industry letters normally ask government to stay out of something. This one asks it to come in, which is what happens when the people building a capability can see the abuse curve running ahead of the defence curve. It also does convenient work for the signatories: a breach caused by one company's model becomes a shared industry problem, and the proposed remedy is a partnership rather than a liability rule.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any of it becomes a mechanism — a reporting requirement, an information-sharing body — rather than a list of logos.

NVIDIA's 70% number is a supply forecast, not a demand one

WHAT HAPPENED

The most consequential line from NVIDIA's Wednesday results only surfaced as Thursday's trading digested the call: CFO Colette Kress told analysts the company expects revenue to grow roughly 70% in fiscal 2028, and described that as a supply-constrained outlook rather than a demand forecast. The figure appears in none of NVIDIA's filed documents — not the [8-K release](#), not the CFO commentary — and NVIDIA published no official transcript, so it rests on secondary transcription. Kress also framed the memory squeeze as self-inflicted: tighter memory supply, she said, is a symptom of the same demand surge driving NVIDIA's own growth. Shares rose 8.74% to \$227.98; [Stifel lifted its target to \\$315 from \\$282](#).

WHAT IT MEANS

If 70% is what the supply chain can deliver rather than what customers want, the binding constraint on AI revenue next year is high-bandwidth memory and advanced packaging, not orders. That makes the memory makers, not NVIDIA, the variable worth watching — and it means an upside surprise has to come from someone else's capacity.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any hyperscaler capex guide corroborates the \$800bn-in-2026 figure, and whether a second HBM4 source is ever named.

Marvell posts a record quarter and drops 8%

WHAT HAPPENED

Marvell reported fiscal second-quarter revenue of \$2.739 billion, up 37% year on year and a company record, with data-centre revenue of \$2.17 billion, up 46%. Non-GAAP earnings were \$0.94 a share against \$0.93 expected (GAAP \$0.33), on a non-GAAP gross margin of 58.9%, and it guided the third quarter to \$3.15 billion plus or minus 5%. On the call — but not in the [written release](#) — management said it had raised its fiscal 2027 outlook by about \$500 million and fiscal 2028 by about \$1.5 billion, to roughly \$18 billion. Shares still fell 7–8.5% after hours, to about \$224 from a close of \$241.45.

WHAT IT MEANS

A beat-and-raise that trades down is a positioning story. Marvell is priced first as a supplier of Google's custom silicon and only second as a networking company, and the quarter gave no update on that partnership. Everything else beat, and it did not matter.

WATCH NEXT

Any Alphabet disclosure on custom-silicon volumes, and whether the FY28 raise shows up in a filed document.

Korea sells the fact

WHAT HAPPENED

Asia's response to the NVIDIA print inverted on Friday. The KOSPI fell 1.79% to 6,789, snapping a three-day rally, with Samsung Electronics opening down 1.41% at 262,500 won and SK hynix down 1.1% at 1,711,000 won. Elsewhere the reaction held: the Nikkei 225 rose 0.29% to 66,323, Taiwan's Taiex gained 0.72% to 46,307.67, and the Hang Seng added about 0.1% to 25,592. Local commentary attributed the Korean move to profit-taking at highs rather than to anything in the numbers.

WHAT IT MEANS

Memory makers are the trade everyone already owns. When the news is unambiguously good and the stock falls anyway, the good news was already in the price — which is a warning about how much of the memory-shortage story is now discounted rather than a verdict on the shortage itself.

WATCH NEXT

September DRAM contract pricing, and whether Samsung or SK hynix says anything about consumer allocation.

BUSINESS

HP sells 16% fewer PCs and books 12.5% more revenue

WHAT HAPPENED

HP's fiscal third quarter, reported Wednesday and traded Thursday: net revenue of \$15.7 billion, up 12.5%; Personal Systems \$11.8 billion, up 18%; Printing \$3.9 billion, down 2%; adjusted earnings of \$0.83 a share, up 10.7%. Total Personal Systems units fell 16% — consumer down 19%, commercial down 14% — and full-year free-cash-flow guidance rose to \$3.0–3.2 billion. HP's [own release](#) credits "meaningful improvements in memory supply and higher fulfillment rates"; the price-rise explanation attached to the quarter elsewhere is commentary, not HP's wording. Shares closed down 2.92% at \$29.63.

WHAT IT MEANS

Eighteen percent more revenue from sixteen percent fewer machines is roughly a 40% swing in average selling price. Whatever HP calls it, that is the memory cost cycle reaching consumer hardware, and it is the first large OEM to show it this plainly in a filed quarter. It also explains the unit decline: the machines got expensive.

WATCH NEXT

Dell's quarter, and whether Lenovo shows the same average-selling-price pattern.

Jackson Hole opens, with Warsh yet to speak

WHAT HAPPENED

The Kansas City Fed's symposium opened Thursday evening at Jackson Lake Lodge on the theme "[Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy](#)." Fed Chair Kevin Warsh gives the keynote at 10:00 a.m. ET today — after this brief was written. Friday's papers: Eswar Prasad on financial innovation and the international monetary system, with Catherine Mann of the Bank of England discussing; Darrell Duffie on tokenised finance, with the ECB's Isabel Schnabel; a payments panel including Kristalina Georgieva; Kenneth Rogoff at lunch. The backdrop is core PCE inflation at 3.3%, real consumer spending flat in July, and a July FOMC that held at 3.50–3.75% with three dissents in favour of a rise.

WHAT IT MEANS

The chosen theme is payments, not rates, which gives Warsh room to say nothing about policy at all. Standard Chartered has argued publicly that he must do the opposite and state plainly that the committee will raise if core inflation does not fall. He has resisted that kind of specificity before.

WATCH NEXT

10:00 a.m. ET. Whether he addresses the two recent Treasury market interventions.

Stocks close higher on NVIDIA; oil turns up

WHAT HAPPENED

US equities closed higher on Thursday. The S&P 500 finished at 7,730.99, up 0.72%; the Nasdaq Composite at 26,541.35, up 1.57%; the Dow Jones Industrial Average at about 53,569, up 0.20%; the Russell 2000 at 3,015.67, up 0.33%. The 10-year Treasury yield ended at 4.67%, a basis point higher on the day. WTI crude settled at \$83.53, up 1.58% — its first meaningful gain of the week — and Brent was quoted around \$88 on Friday morning, ending a four-session slide. Gold traded near \$4,589.

WHAT IT MEANS

Oil rising while the Strait of Hormuz corridor talks continue is the market marking down the odds that the corridor actually reopens traffic soon. The four-day slide was priced on an announcement; the bounce is priced on the detail not arriving.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Oman publishes coordinates and a start date for the corridor.

SoftBank said to be seeking control of humanoid maker 1X

WHAT HAPPENED

SoftBank is in talks to buy a majority stake in 1X Technologies, the Norwegian-American humanoid robot company, at a valuation of about \$6 billion, according to [reporting on Thursday](#). The story originates with The Information and every subsequent write-up traces back to it — neither SoftBank nor 1X has said anything, and no independent second report exists. Treat it as a single-source scoop, not a deal. It was cited as a factor in SoftBank's slightly firmer open in Tokyo on Friday.

WHAT IT MEANS

If it holds, it is the largest declared bet yet that humanoids are a 2020s product rather than a 2030s one, and it fits SoftBank's pattern of taking control rather than a minority position when it believes a category is about to inflect. It would also give SoftBank a hardware asset to point at alongside its Arm and OpenAI positions.

WATCH NEXT

A SoftBank filing or a 1X statement. Absent either, this stays a rumour.

Motion raises \$2m to rent out humanoid robots by the month

WHAT HAPPENED

Brussels-based Motion, founded this year, raised a \$2 million pre-seed [led by Extantia Capital](#), with Norrsken Evolve also participating. It rents humanoid robots on a monthly subscription that bundles deployment, training, integration, financing, insurance and maintenance, and is running five pilots in Belgium. Chief executive Alexander Stevens: "Europe has a robot adoption problem. Adoption fails on financing, risk and compliance long before it fails on technology." No valuation was disclosed.

WHAT IT MEANS

The interesting claim is not the robots, which Motion does not make. It is that the barrier to European industrial automation is a balance-sheet and liability problem, and that whoever absorbs it captures the margin. That is the same insight that built equipment leasing, applied a category early.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any of the five Belgian pilots converts to a production contract.

Breedr takes \$27m to track cattle one animal at a time

WHAT HAPPENED

Breedr raised a \$27 million Series B [led by Partech](#), with LocalGlobe and Outsiders Fund participating. The company tracks more than 2.5 million cattle across 2,000-plus ranchers using weigh-scale and tissue-sample data, runs a cattle marketing group with roughly \$500 million in annualised trading volume, and lends to ranchers. Founder Ian Wheal describes the shift as "moving from group-level information... to individual animal tracking," enabling decisions "from embryo to carcass." No valuation disclosed. The round was announced late Wednesday and landed in Thursday's cycle.

WHAT IT MEANS

The financing arm is the business. Individual-animal data turns a herd into collateral a lender can actually underwrite, which is why an agriculture software company is worth a Series B at this size.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the trading volume figure is ever audited or restated.

Talwani blocks the mail-ballot rule again, hours after it took effect

WHAT HAPPENED

The USPS mail-ballot rule took effect on Thursday. By the end of the day, US District Judge Indira Talwani had issued a fresh temporary restraining order blocking its core provisions — the requirement that states hand USPS their voter lists, the unique barcodes on ballot envelopes, and the Postal Service's claimed authority to refuse ballots that do not comply. She wrote: "The court is unaware of, and no party has proffered, any delegation Congress has made that would permit the USPS to regulate election mail." The order came in two [consolidated cases](#) — *League of Women Voters v. Trump* and *California v. USPS*, the latter filed on 26 August by [25 jurisdictions](#). A combined preliminary-injunction hearing is set for 3 September.

WHAT IT MEANS

This is the third posture in four days: nationwide injunction, dissolution, new TRO. The substance has not changed — Talwani thinks the Postal Service has no statutory authority here — but the vehicle has, and it now rests on a consolidated record rather than a single suit, which is harder to unwind on an emergency application. The Supreme Court's earlier stay reached only plaintiff states; this order does not have that limit.

WATCH NEXT

The 3 September hearing, and whether the administration goes back to the Supreme Court before North Carolina begins mailing ballots on 4 September.

Cook's lawyers put the removal case in writing

WHAT HAPPENED

Fed governor Lisa Cook's attorneys, Abbe Lowell and Norman Eisen, sent a formal response on Thursday to the administration's mortgage-fraud allegations, [writing](#): "For the second time in a year, we have explained why there is no legal basis for President Trump to remove Governor Cook for cause," and calling the campaign "an attempt by President Trump to force the Federal Reserve to bend to his will." The letter answers a 7 August demand from White House deputy chief of staff Dan Scavino that set a 26 August deadline. No formal removal proceeding has been opened, and Cook remains in post.

WHAT IT MEANS

Nothing has been filed anywhere, which is the point. The administration is testing whether a letter alone can produce a resignation, because the moment it acts formally it creates a defendant with standing and puts "for cause" removal of a Fed governor in front of a court — a question that has never been litigated to judgment.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the White House opens a formal review. That, not the letters, is the trigger.

Hong Kong hears mitigation for the vigil organisers; sentencing within two weeks

WHAT HAPPENED

Hong Kong's High Court on Friday heard mitigation for Lee Cheuk-yan, 69, Chow Hang-tung, 41, and Albert Ho, 74, the former leaders of the Hong Kong Alliance, convicted on 21 August of inciting subversion under the national security law. No sentence was passed. Judge Alex Lee said he would rule within two weeks and set no date. Chow, representing herself, told the court: "If the law truly has no room for our beliefs, then I would rather be a criminal than be a fake person." Erik Shum, for Lee and Ho, argued their advocacy involved no violence. The exposure is five to ten years if the court finds the circumstances serious, up to five years if minor. ([AP](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

The two-week gap is the story. A short sentence reads as leniency the government has not signalled; a long one settles whether commemorating 4 June is now a serious crime, and the court plainly wants that written down carefully. Ho has already served more than four years on remand.

WATCH NEXT

The sentencing date, and whether time served is credited in full.

Qatar shuttles to Tehran on Hormuz; Trump raises Chinese banks

WHAT HAPPENED

Qatar's prime minister and foreign minister, Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani, met Araghchi, President Pezeshkian, speaker Ghalibaf and security chief Mohsen Rezai in Tehran on Thursday to discuss the temporary Strait of Hormuz corridor and a joint mine-clearing effort. Rezai's position, via Iranian media: "The US must first take practical steps to fulfil Iran's conditions and then Iran will proceed to open the Strait of Hormuz." Oman has now spoken in its own name, publishing a joint Omani-Iranian statement on 25 August proposing the corridor. Separately, President Trump said Washington is not talking to Iran and hinted at sanctions on Chinese banks doing business with it — a single liveblog report; OFAC's only action this week was an amended Venezuela licence. ([Al Jazeera](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

Two mediators are now working the same file, which usually means neither has the mandate to close it. Iran has moved from announcing a corridor to pricing it, and the price is American concessions first. The Chinese-bank threat is the live escalation risk: the one measure that would actually move oil, and the one the administration has repeatedly declined to take ahead of Xi's Washington visit on 24 September.

WATCH NEXT

Coordinates and a start date for the corridor. And [ofac.treasury.gov](#) — a named Chinese bank changes the story completely.

Russia strikes nine Ukrainian cities overnight

WHAT HAPPENED

Russia mounted what its defence ministry called a massive overnight barrage across nine Ukrainian cities into Thursday, claiming it hit "industrial facilities, oil refineries, logistics hubs and port infrastructure" — a state account of its own operation, unverified. Ukrainian officials reported at least two killed, a 78-year-old woman in Zaporizhzhia and one person in Kharkiv, with more than fourteen wounded. Ukraine's air force said it downed or suppressed seven ballistic missiles; that too is a party's account of its own operation. Zelensky: "Russia continues to invest in missiles and in expanding its war, and that means more countermeasures are needed."

WHAT IT MEANS

The target list Moscow describes — refineries, ports, logistics — mirrors what Ukraine has been hitting inside Russia all month. This is now symmetrical energy-infrastructure warfare heading into the heating season, and neither side's damage claims are checkable from outside.

WATCH NEXT

Whether European gas markets react, with EU storage still around 60% against an 82% norm.

SOURCES

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[100+ companies call for action against rogue AI — TechCrunch](#)

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[SoftBank in talks for majority stake in 1X \(single-source\) — TechStartups](#)

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[AG Campbell sues USPS \(25-jurisdiction complaint\) — Mass. AG](#)

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[Hong Kong court hears sentencing arguments for vigil organisers — AP via ClickOnDetroit](#)

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[Joint Omani-Iranian statement — Oman Ministry of Foreign Affairs](#)

[Recent OFAC actions — US Treasury](#)

[Russia bombards nine Ukrainian cities overnight — AP via KSAT](#)